

» AFTER

Following the fall of Richmond, the Confederacy became a country and a cause without a capital. Lee's retreating army was its only remaining bulwark.



LINCOLN IN RICHMOND

EVACUATING RICHMOND

Jefferson Davis used the city's **last rail link** to **escape to Danville**, 130 miles (210km) to the southwest, where he issued a **defiant promise** to continue the struggle.

LINCOLN'S TRIUMPH

In contrast, **Abraham Lincoln** who happened to be visiting the Army of the Potomac when Richmond fell, **traveled into the city** barely a day after Davis had left it. He was **welcomed as a liberator** by the city's Black population. "You are free, free as air," the President told them. But **Lincoln would die** within two weeks (see [Lincoln fights for survival](#)).

LAST BATTLES

Lee **hoped to escape** with his army to the Danville area and **fight on**, but the **move was blocked by Grant** (see [The pursuit westward](#)). With this, Lee had no option left but to surrender.